reasoning, and see at the end that she's thanked *me* for years of intense instruction in mathematics and physics after a Tony Robbins seminar persuaded her to overcome her fears and pursue her inner physicist. Yikes, I think. She'd just enrolled in that seminar when I embarked on my trip to the future. I'd better head back to my own time to begin the instruction.

Well, I go back in time and begin to tutor my mother in string theory. But it's not going well. A year goes by. Then two. And although she's trying hard, she's just not getting it. I'm starting to worry. We stay at it for another couple of years, but progress is minimal. Now I'm really worried. There is not much time left before her paper is supposed to appear. How is she going to write it? Finally, I make the big decision. When I read her paper in the future, it left such an impression on me that I remember it clear as day. And so, instead of having her discover it on her own—something that's looking less and less likely—I tell her what to write, making sure she includes everything exactly as I remember reading it. She releases the paper, and in short order it sets the physics world on fire. All that I read about during my time in the future comes to pass.

Now here's the puzzling issue. Who should get the credit for my mother's groundbreaking paper? I certainly shouldn't. I learned of the results by reading them in her paper. Yet how can my mother take credit, when she wrote only what I told her to? Of course, the issue here is not really one of credit—it's the issue of where the new knowledge, new insights, and new understanding presented in my mother's paper came from. To what can I point and say, "This person or this computer came up with the new results"? I didn't have the insights, nor did my mother, there wasn't anyone else involved, and we didn't use a computer. Nevertheless, somehow these brilliant results are all in her paper. Apparently, in a world that allows time travel both to the future and to the past, knowledge can materialize out of thin air. Although not quite as paradoxical as preventing your own birth, this is positively weird.

What should we make of such paradox and weirdness? Should we conclude that while time travel to the future is allowed by the laws of physics, any attempt to return to the past must fail? Some have certainly thought so. But, as we'll now see, there are ways around the tricky issues